During the crisis, Rajeev Chandrasekhar of the BJP stated that “Doklam Heralds the Arrival of a Confident and Assertive India.”[45] The Indian newspaper *The Economic Times* later claimed that Doklam would “have a profound impact on the geopolitical standing of both New Delhi and Beijing.”[46] Pointing out that, rather than India’s unilateral removal of its troops, as had been demanded by China, the two countries resolved to mutually withdraw their forces, the newspaper argued that India has demonstrated strength.

Although Indian commentators have argued that as a result of the Doklam incident, India gained a stronger position vis-à-vis China,[47] others have debated whether either country “won” or “lost” the border standoff.[48] Although the standoff eventually ended in late August 2017, the actual conflict remains unresolved, and the area has become heavily militarised.[49] The important take-away for the purpose of this chapter, however, is that New Delhi was willing to confront Beijing and that India showed no intention of accommodating Chinese interests in this incident. Thus, the Doklam incident highlighted the Modi government’s willingness to face and respond to Chinese advances in India’s neighbourhood.

Despite several rounds of bilateral border negotiations since the 1980s, India’s border dispute with China has not been solved, and although the two countries have put in place a number of confidence-building measures (CBMs) along the border, tensions still occasionally flare up. In fact, with both China and India developing infrastructure on both sides of the Himalayas, it could be argued that the risk of tension and conflict has increased in recent years. India began to strengthen its border defences against China in the mid-2000s, raising two new divisions for the mountains; deploying Sukhoi 30 fighter jets to Jammu, Kashmir, and Assam; and improving roads in the border area.[50]